

Stop Teaching It Away. Start Selling It.

A simple playbook for founders and creators who want their content to build trust **and** drive sales — not just give away free lessons.

The problem with “helpful” content

Most business owners are told to “share value” and “teach what you know.” So they post step-by-step tutorials, how-to guides, and free breakdowns of their entire process. It feels generous. It gets likes and comments. And it quietly trains their audience to solve the problem **without them**.

Educational content answers the question “How do I do this?” The moment you answer it fully, the viewer has what they came for. There is no reason left to hire you, buy from you, or book a call — you already gave them the outcome for free.

This guide shows a different approach: **myth-busting content**. Instead of teaching a skill, you correct a wrong belief. That does two things a tutorial never can — it makes you look like the authority who sees what others miss, and it leaves the reader needing you to actually fix it.

THE CORE IDEA

Educational content builds an audience. Myth-busting content builds **buyers**. Teach people *what* is true and why — not the full *how* to do it themselves. Save the “how” for paying customers.

Education vs. myth-busting, side by side

Educational content	Myth-busting content
“Here’s how to do X, step by step.”	“Here’s why what you believe about X is costing you.”
Makes the viewer self-sufficient	Makes the viewer question their own judgment
Positions you as a generous teacher	Positions you as the authority who sees the trap
Ends with “now I know”	Ends with “now I need help doing this right”

You are not hiding information or being dishonest — you are simply choosing to sell the correct thinking, and reserve the full execution for people who work with you.

Step 1 — Find myths worth busting

A good myth isn't just "something people get wrong." It needs to meet four conditions before it's worth a post:

- **Widely believed** — you've heard it from several customers, comments, or competitors.
- **Costly** — believing it wastes people's time, money, or results.
- **Provable** — you can show it's wrong with a client story, data, or your own experience.
- **Fixable only with expertise** — knowing the truth isn't enough; doing it right still needs skill, judgment, or hands-on help.

Where to find them:

- Questions and objections you hear on sales calls or in DMs
- Comments where people repeat "common knowledge" that hurt them
- Claims your competitors make that you know are outdated or oversimplified
- Something *you* used to believe, before experience proved you wrong

Step 2 — The myth-busting content formula

Use this five-part structure for every myth-busting post, video, or newsletter. It keeps you sounding like an authority, not a critic.

1. Name the myth

State it in the exact words your audience uses. "You need to post daily to grow."

2. Validate why it feels true

Show you understand why people believe it. This builds trust instead of making them feel foolish.

3. Reveal the truth

Prove it wrong with a real result, data point, or short story — not just an opinion.

4. Give the correct principle (not the full how-to)

Share what to do instead, at the level of a rule of thumb — stop short of the full step-by-step system.

5. Point to the real cost of getting it wrong

Connect it to something bigger they're risking, and let that lead naturally into your offer.

Worked example

MYTH: “You have to post every single day to grow on social media.”

Why it feels true: the loudest advice online is about consistency, and more posting does correlate with more reach for some accounts.

The truth: a client of ours cut posting from daily to 3x a week, spent the extra time on offer clarity and hooks, and grew faster — volume was never the real lever.

Do this instead: match frequency to how much genuinely new insight you have, not to a calendar.

The real cost: daily posting without a strategy burns you out and trains your audience to expect noise instead of value — which is the first thing we fix inside our content coaching program.

Step 3 — Sound like the authority

The same facts can sound like a lecture or like an authority speaking. Small language choices make the difference:

- “Most people think... that’s backwards” — names the belief before correcting it
- “I used to believe this too, until...” — borrows credibility from your own experience
- “Here’s what actually moves the needle” — signals you know something the crowd doesn’t
- Use specific numbers, timeframes, and before/after results instead of vague claims
- Correct the *belief*, never the *person* — you’re debunking bad advice they were fed, not judging them for believing it

Step 4 — End with a bridge, not just a CTA

A weak call-to-action asks for attention. A strong bridge shows the myth is only one piece of a bigger picture you help people navigate.

Weak CTA	Bridge CTA
“DM me to learn more.”	“This is mistake #1 out of 12 we catch in our free content audit — want your other 11?”
“Follow for more tips.”	“Getting this right is step one. Steps two through five are what we walk clients through inside [program].”

Before you publish: a 30-second checklist

- Does this correct a belief, rather than teach the full skill?
- Would the reader still need help after reading this?
- Did I validate why the myth is believable, instead of mocking it?
- Is there real proof — a story, result, or number — behind the correction?
- Does it end by pointing toward my offer, naturally?

The one rule to remember

**“Give away the truth.
Sell the execution.”**

Your goal was never to withhold help. It's to sell the right depth of it — the correct belief, for free; the correct execution, for paying customers.

Where to start this week

- Pick **one** myth from the list you hear most often from customers or in your comments.
- Run it through the five-part formula on page 2 — name it, validate it, bust it, redirect it, and raise the stakes.
- End with a bridge, not a bare CTA — make it obvious that fixing this myth is only step one of what you offer.